

Northstar Labs — 04 Policies

Fictional reference document created for RAG retrieval, chunking, embedding, vector search, metadata filtering, and multi-document QA testing.

1. Access Control

Northstar applies least-privilege access to customer and internal systems.

Authorization must confirm that a principal can access the requested resource and organization. Sensitive administrative access is reviewed quarterly.

Testing note: This section contains source-of-truth fictional facts for semantic retrieval. Related concepts may appear in other documents with different details, allowing comparison of source relevance.

2. Data Retention

Retention depends on data category and operational purpose.

Execution history has configurable retention limits by plan. Temporary processing files should be deleted after their processing window unless a documented requirement exists.

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3. API Security

Protected API resources require authentication and authorization.

Tokens must not be committed to source code or exposed in client bundles. Rate limits protect shared infrastructure and external dependencies.

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4. OAuth Policy

OAuth is used when an application needs delegated access to a user's external account.

The authorization flow includes client ID, redirect URI, scopes, and state. The backend exchanges the authorization code for tokens and stores them securely.

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5. AI and RAG Policy

AI systems must distinguish retrieved evidence from generated language.

RAG retrieval must respect user authorization. When evidence is insufficient, the assistant should communicate uncertainty instead of inventing a document, policy, person, or value.

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6. Document Management

Knowledge documents should have source, owner, status, publication date, and access scope.

Archived documents must be marked clearly. When a policy changes, the new version should receive a new publication timestamp or version identifier.

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7. Incident Response

Critical incidents include widespread unavailability, severe security exposure, or major data integrity concerns.

Customer communication should state known impact and mitigation progress without making unsupported root-cause claims.

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8. Change Management

Production changes must be traceable and reversible when practical.

High-risk changes may use staged rollout, feature flags, or canary deployment. Database migrations must remain compatible during rollout.

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9. Backup and Recovery

Critical data receives scheduled backups and recovery testing.

Recovery point objective describes acceptable data loss; recovery time objective describes target restoration time. Different systems may have different objectives.

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10. Governance

Access reviews occur quarterly and OAuth refresh tokens are sensitive credentials.

RAG retrieval must respect authorization boundaries, archived documents should be clearly marked, and production changes should be traceable.

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